



1841-95
BERTHE MORISOT

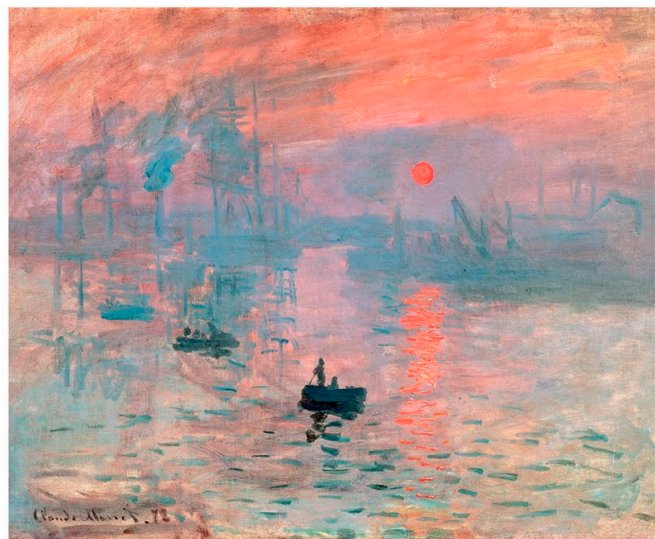
French painter Berthe Morisot was one of few women among the early Impressionists. The Académie des Beaux-Arts accepted her work, but she also exhibited with the Impressionists in their shows.

1874 FIRST IMPRESSIONIST EXHIBITION

After years of rejection by the French Académie des Beaux-Arts, a group of Impressionist painters organized their own exhibition in Paris. It showed 165 works by 30 artists, including Claude Monet's

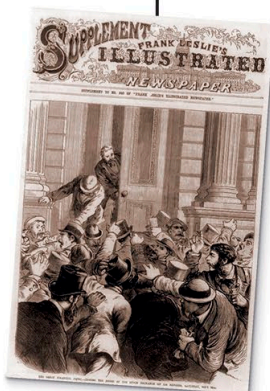
Impression, Sunrise. Critics mocked the broad, unblended brushstrokes and bright colours that characterized Impressionism; some called the paintings the work of "lunatics" or comedians.

▷ *Impression, Sunrise*, Claude Monet



1873 Spain becomes a republic after King Amadeo I abdicates during the Third Carlist War (1872-76)

1874



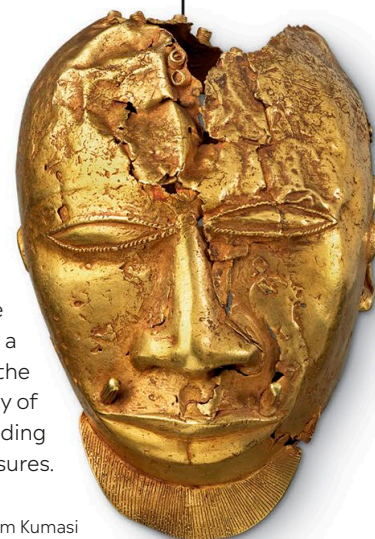
1873-96 WORLDWIDE DEPRESSION

For more than two decades, the world was gripped by a financial crisis caused by panics on the Vienna, New York, and Paris stock markets, a tariff war between France and Italy, and an increase in protectionism. The crisis realigned the world's economies, with the US emerging first from the slump and replacing Great Britain as the world's leading industrial power.

◁ New York Stock Exchange panic

1874 THE ASHANTI CAPITAL, KUMASI, IS DESTROYED

Between 1824 and 1900, there were five wars between the Ashanti Empire of West Africa and Great Britain. In 1874, a British force destroyed the earth and stone palace of the *Asantehene* (king) at Kumasi and imposed an indemnity of 50,000 ounces of gold, which the Ashanti paid in part by handing over gold masks, jewellery, and other treasures.



▷ Solid gold head from Kumasi